

of the names of Vishtaspa and his queen Hutaosa in the father of Darius and the daughter of Cyrus. Antiquity even tended to confuse the two royal Vishtaspas, which may be taken as a slight indication that the name was not common. The repetition of this very significant name in the family of a monarch whose Zoroastrian faith is attested by many lines of evidence, as we shall show, is by itself suggestive. But of course, if Vishtaspa's name is significant for Darius's branch of the Achæmenians, Hutaosa's must be equally significant for that of Cyrus. The names must at least prove, I think, that the memory of the great king was kept alive in both branches of the family; nor is it unlikely that it was cherished on religious as well as on secular grounds. But when we remember how quickly after Zarathushtra's time all but the most superficial features of his teaching were practically lost, and only rediscovered in an esoteric circle by the preservation of the Gathas in worship—a subject which will come before us in Lecture III.—we realise that to prove Cyrus a Zoroastrian in any effective sense demands evidence that his ancestors had maintained the traditional lore in a country where the religion of the people was wholly alien in spirit, and in the face of a powerful tendency, observable in all the metrical Later Avesta itself, to fall back upon the old Iranian nature-worship. As a great champion of Mazdah-worship Vishtaspa might well be commemorated in Cyrus's family; but there is complete absence of proof that for Cyrus his name signified more than this, which we have seen to be on other grounds very probable.